

IPL Cricket Analytics Dashboard

Five Data Questions | IPL 2008-2025 | Angajala Gautam Raju

Lead Finding - The Toss Trap

Teams optimise intensely for a toss that explains almost no outcome variance (51.8% win rate). The IPL's version of over-indexing on the wrong KPI - but venue segmentation reveals where it actually matters.

Q1 - The Toss Trap

IPL toss winners convert to match winners only 51.8% of the time across 1,169 valid matches - statistically indistinguishable from a coin flip. Teams have shifted overwhelmingly toward choosing to field (50% in 2008-12 to 76% in 2018-25), yet the fielding-first win rate is declining (55.7% to 53.7%). Venue segmentation reveals the real story: Jaipur shows >70% toss win rate in Era 3 while Dubai shows <42%. Teams are optimising hard for the wrong KPI.

Q2 - Death Over Specialists

Among 89 bowlers with at least 200 death-over balls (overs 16-20), Malinga and Bollinger lead on combined economy and wicket rate. Economy rate is adjusted for opposition strength - a bowler conceding 9 RPO against Mumbai Indians deserves more credit than one doing the same against a weaker side. The scatter reveals the rarest profile in T20 cricket: bowlers who both contain and take wickets when pressure is highest.

Q3 - The Run Rate Revolution

All three phases of IPL innings have become more batting-friendly since 2008. Powerplay scoring rose +2.00 RPO (2008 to 2025) as openers became increasingly aggressive. Death-over scoring spiked sharply in 2022 (+1.04 RPO in one season), coinciding with the rise of specialist finishers. Middle overs show the smallest shift - that phase remains the most contested battleground in T20. This decomposition shows not just that the game changed, but when and where.

Q4 - Team Strategy Alpha

Expected runs are calculated as the average innings score at the same venue, in the same innings position, in the same era. Gujarat Titans and Chennai Super Kings lead at +3.7 runs per innings above venue expectation. Delhi Capitals are the lowest at -4.0 runs per innings. This metric controls for venue context so that a team scoring 180 at Chepauk is evaluated differently from one scoring 180 at Wankhede - revealing coaching and strategic quality beyond raw talent.

Q5 - Home Ground Advantage

Home advantage is real but franchise-specific. Rajasthan Royals show the strongest edge (68.1% at home vs 42.0% away, +26.1pp differential), likely driven by their spin-friendly Jaipur wicket. Gujarat Titans and Lucknow Super Giants - newer franchises - actually perform better away than at home (-11pp and -13pp), suggesting they rely on squad quality over venue familiarity. The 2020 UAE season (all-neutral) is excluded and serves as a natural experiment confirming the home advantage effect.